PHOTOGRAPHS BY RICHARD FINDLEY

How to successfully part off spindle work

Richard Findley takes a look at the best way to part off your spindle work

RICHARD FINDLEY

Richard is a registered UK professional woodturner living and working in Leicestershire. He discovered woodturning while working for his father as a joiner. He makes all kinds of work to commission, from replacement antique components, walking canes and stair spindles, to decorative bowls. It is the variety of work that he loves. He also offers demonstrations and a range of woodturning supplies.

richard@turnersworkshop.co.uk
www.turnersworkshop.co.uk
Follow on Instagram: richard_findley

The action of 'parting off' is to separate the item you have been turning from a section of waste that is usually attached to a driving centre. Parting is not something that is needed every time you work on your lathe, but on those occasions when you need it, having the confidence to carry it out successfully will be of great benefit. I would usually part off items that are held between centres, that have one end that doesn't matter about drive marks, such as drawer pulls or handles of one sort or another.

Items such as table legs or stair spindles, where neither end will be seen, won't need parting off. Some items will have waste portions at both ends, such as the spheres I made in *Woodturning* 289. In this case, you can part the work on the lathe, but you will need to remove the waste from the other end by another method, so there may not be a benefit in parting on the lathe: the choice is yours.

The action of parting off is relatively simple, but there are a number of pitfalls that are just waiting to trip up the unwary turner. It is these pitfalls that I intend to highlight and show how to avoid in this article.

WT_291_21_24_RICHARD_FINDLEY_TECH_vsMBrfbdSD.indd 21 02/03/2016 09:33